A regular meeting of the Board of Aldermen was held Tuesday, March 24, 2026, at 7:45 p.m. in the aldermanic chamber, and duly noticed in two places, including the City's website, in accordance with the requirements of RSA 91-A:2 II.

President Lori Wilshire presided; City Clerk Dan Healey recorded.

Prayer was offered by City Clerk Dan Healey; Alderman-at-Large Ben Clemons, led in the Pledge to the Flag.

Let's start the meeting by taking a roll call attendance.

The roll call was taken with 15 members of the Board of Aldermen present: Alderman Clemons, Alderman Klee, Alderman Chess, Alderwoman Smith, Alderman Thibeault, Alderman O'Brien, Alderman Gregg, Alderman Dowd, Alderman Sullivan, Alderman Sennott, Alderman Johnson, Alderwoman Kelly, Alderman Morgan, Alderman Lopez, Alderman Wilshire.

Mayor James W. Donchess and Corporation Counsel Steve Bolton were also in attendance.

REMARKS BY THE MAYOR

Mayor Donchess

RESPONSE TO REMARKS OF THE MAYOR

Klee

RECOGNITION PERIOD - None

READING MINUTES OF PREVIOUS MEETINGS

There being no objection, President Wilshire declared the minutes of the regular Board of Aldermen meeting of March 10, 2026 be accepted, placed on file, and the readings suspended.

COMMUNICATIONS REQUIRING ONLY PROCEDURAL ACTIONS AND WRITTEN REPORTS FROM LIAISONS

From: Rich Lannan, Chair, Nashua Center for the Arts Board of Trustees
Re: Nashua Center for the Arts Board of Trustees Annual Report

From: Liz Hannum, Economic Development Director
Re: Disposition of 342 Main Street - Upcoming Request for Proposals (RFP)

There being no objection, President Wilshire accepted the communications and placed them on file.

PERIOD FOR PUBLIC COMMENT RELATIVE TO ITEMS EXPECTED TO BE ACTED UPON THIS EVENING

Susan Elberger
Betsey Martel
Elle Millar
Kristy Ayi
Gary Hoffman
Lindsay Rinaldi
David Harris
Jennifer Amand
Deb Kneeland
Fred Teeboom
Walter Schier
Jim Larson

COMMUNICATIONS REQUIRING FINAL APPROVAL

From: Liz Hannum, Economic Development Director
Re: Arts Commission Spending Recommendation

MOTION BY ALDERWOMAN KELLY TO APPROVE $30,000 TO ARTS RELATED GRANTS AS OUTLINED IN THE FEBRUARY 3, 2026 MEMO FROM DIRECTOR LIZ HANNUM ON BEHALF O THE ARTS COMMISISON, BY ROLL CALL

A viva voce roll call was taken, which resulted as follows:

Yea: Alderman Clemons, Alderman Klee, Alderman Chess, Alderwoman Smith, Alderman Thibeault, Alderman O'Brien, Alderman Gregg, Alderman Dowd, Alderman Sullivan, Alderman Sennott, Alderman Johnson, Alderwoman Kelly, Alderman Morgan, Alderman Lopez, Alderman Wilshire 15

Nay: 0

MOTION CARRIED

From: Mayor Jim Donchess
Re: Multi-Year Contract Award - Employee Assistance Program Provider

MOTION BY ALDERMAN KLEE TO ACCEPT, PLACE ON FILE, AND AWARD A THREE-YEAR CONTRACT TO COMPPSYCH AS THE CITY'S EMPLOYEE ASSSISTANCE PROGRAM (EAP) THAT WILL IMPROVE ACCESS TO SERVICES, EXPANDING COUNSELING SUPPORT, AND ASSIST WITH EARLY INTERVENTION RESOURCES IN THE AMOUNT NOT TO EXCEED $61,240. FUNDING WILL BE THROUGH DEPARTMENT: 113 BENEFITS; FUND: BENEFITS SELF INSURANCE FUND/52 – FRINGE BENEFITS, BY ROLL CALL

A viva voce roll call was taken, which resulted as follows:

Yea: Alderman Clemons, Alderman Klee, Alderman Chess, Alderwoman Smith, Alderman Thibeault, Alderman O'Brien, Alderman Gregg, Alderman Dowd, Alderman Sullivan, Alderman Sennott, Alderman Johnson, Alderwoman Kelly, Alderman Morgan, Alderman Lopez, Alderman Wilshire 15

Nay: 0

MOTION CARRIED

From: Mayor Jim Donchess
Re: Million Dollar Contract Award - Hydropower Engineering Change Order #5

MOTION BY ALDERMAN SULLIVAN TO ACCEPT, PLACE ON FILE, AND APPROVE CHANGE ORDER #5 TO THE VERDANTAS CONTRACT TO SUPPORT ADDITIONAL SCOPE FOR THE CONTRACT THAT INCLUDES WATER QUALITY STUDIES TO BE PERFORMED IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE NH DES ISSUED WATER QUALITY CERTIFICATION REQUIREMENTS IN THE AMOUNT NOT TO EXCEED $196,942.00. FUNDING WILL BE THROUGH DEPARTMENT: 170 HYDROELECTRIC OPERATIONS; FUND: MINE FALLS TRUST/53 – PROFESSIONAL & TECHNICAL SERVICES, BY ROLL CALL

A viva voce roll call was taken, which resulted as follows:

Yea: Alderman Clemons, Alderman Klee, Alderman Chess, Alderwoman Smith, Alderman Thibeault, Alderman O'Brien, Alderman Gregg, Alderman Dowd, Alderman Sullivan, Alderman Sennott, Alderman Johnson, Alderwoman Kelly, Alderman Morgan, Alderman Lopez, Alderman Wilshire 15

Nay: 0

MOTION CARRIED

From: Mayor Jim Donchess
Re: Million Dollar Contract Award - Operation and Maintenance of the Hydroelectric facilities

MOTION BY ALDERMAN GREGG TO ACCEPT, PLACE ON FILE, AND APPROVE CHANGE ORDER #1 WITH ESSEX POWER SERVICE RELATIVE TO EXPENSES REQUIRED TO REPAIR UNIT #1 AT THE MINE FALLS FACILITY IN THE AMOUNT NOT TO EXCEED $436,000. FUNDING WILL BE THROUGH DEPARTMENT: 170 HYDROELECTRIC OPERATIONS; FUND: MINE FALLS TRUST/53-PROFESSIONAL & TECHNICAL SERVICES, BY ROLL CALL

A viva voce roll call was taken, which resulted as follows:

Yea: Alderman Clemons, Alderman Klee, Alderman Chess, Alderwoman Smith, Alderman Thibeault, Alderman O'Brien, Alderman Gregg, Alderman Dowd, Alderman Sullivan, Alderman Sennott, Alderman Johnson, Alderwoman Kelly, Alderman Morgan, Alderman Lopez, Alderman Wilshire 15

Nay: 0

MOTION CARRIED

From: Mayor Jim Donchess
Re: Multi-Year Contract Award - Software Subscription: Policeapp.com

MOTION BY ALDERMAN KLEE TO ACCEPT, PLACE ON FILE, AND APROVE THE RENEWAL OF A THREE-YEAR SOFTWARE CONTRACT WITH POLICEAPP.COM, INC., FOR THE RECRUITMENT OF SWORN PERSONNEL IN THE AMOUNT NOT TO EXCEED $6,500 ANNUALLY. FUNDING WILL BE THROUGH DEPARTMENT: 150 POLICE DEPARTMENT; FUND: GENERAL FUND/55 – OTHER SERVICES

A viva voce roll call was taken, which resulted as follows:

Yea: Alderman Clemons, Alderman Klee, Alderman Chess, Alderwoman Smith, Alderman Thibeault, Alderman O'Brien, Alderman Gregg, Alderman Dowd, Alderman Sullivan, Alderman Sennott, Alderman Johnson, Alderwoman Kelly, Alderman Morgan, Alderman Lopez, Alderman Wilshire 15

Nay: 0

MOTION CARRIED

PETITIONS - None

NOMINATIONS, APPOINTMENTS AND ELECTIONS

The following appointments by the Mayor were read into the record:

Arts Commission

Lauren Spira-Savett (re-appointment) Term to expire: May 31, 2028
39 Coburn Avenue
Nashua, NH 03063

Sara Ceaser (re-appointment) Term to expire: April 1, 2028
15 Pike Street, Apt. B
Nashua, NH 03060

Cultural Connections Committee

Joslyn Kuchinski (new appointment) Term to expire: April 14, 2029
179 Pepperell Road
Hollis, NH 03049

Planning Board

Lawrence Hirsch (re-appointment) Term to expire: March 31, 2029
12 Salmon Brook Drive
Nashua, NH 03062

There being no objection, President Wilshire accepted the Appointments by the Mayor as read and referred them to the Personnel/Administrative Affairs Committee.

REPORTS OF COMMITTEE

Joint Meeting - Committee on Infrastructure and Board of Public Works……..… 02/25/2026

There being no objection, President Wilshire declared the report of the February 25, 2026 Joint Meeting -Committee on Infrastructure and Board of Public Works be accepted and placed on file.

There being no objection, President Wilshire suspended the rules to allow for the oral report of the Budget Review Committee meeting held Monday, March 23rd, regarding proposed amended Resolutions R-26-003 and R-26-007.

Alderman Dowd gave an oral report of the Budget Review Committee meeting of March 23, 2026 with respect to amended Resolutions R-26-003 and R-26-007.

Joint Convention with Woodlawn/Pinewood Cemeteries Board of Trustees

There being no objection, President Lori Wilshire declared that the Board of Aldermen meet in joint convention with the Woodlawn/Pinewood Cemetery Trustees for the purpose of electing two Trustees and called for nominations.

Trustee Niles Jensen nominated Todd Whitney and Mark Coulombe for a five-year terms to expire March 31, 2030.

There being no objection, President Wilshire closed the nominations.

A viva voce roll call was taken on the appointments of Todd Whitney and Mark Coulombe which result as follows:

Yea: Alderman Clemons, Alderman Klee, Alderman Chess, Alderwoman Smith, Alderman Thibeault, Alderman O'Brien, Alderman Gregg, Alderman Dowd, Alderman Sullivan, Alderman Sennott, Alderman Johnson, Alderwoman Kelly, Alderman Morgan, Alderman Lopez, Alderman Wilshire

Trustee Coulombe, Mayor Donchess, Trustee Farwell, Trustee Jensen, Trustee McLaughlin, Trustee Whitney, Trustee Plamondon 22

Nay: 0

MOTION CARRIED

Oath of Office administered by Corporation Counsel for Trustee Todd Whitney and Trustee Mark Coulombe.

Joint Convention with Library Board of Trustees - Kristin Kane and Ernest A. Jette nominations

There being no objection, President Lori Wilshire declared that the Board of Aldermen meet in joint convention with the Library Board of Trustees for the purpose of electing two Trustees and called for nominations.

Trustee Linda Laflamme nominated Kristin Kane for a seven year term to expire March 31, 2033 and Ernest A. Jette for the remaining two years of a seven-year term to expire March 31, 2028.

There being no objection, President Wilshire closed the nominations.

A viva voce roll call was taken on the appointments of Kristin Kane and Ernest A. Jette which result as follows:

Yea: Alderman Clemons, Alderman Klee, Alderman Chess, Alderwoman Smith, Alderman Thibeault, Alderman O'Brien, Alderman Gregg, Alderman Dowd,

Alderman Sullivan, Alderman Sennott, Alderman Johnson, Alderwoman Kelly, Alderman Morgan, Alderman Lopez, Alderman Wilshire

Trustee Dresner, Trustee Jaquith, Trustee Kennedy, Trustee Laflamme, Mayor Donchess 20

Nay: 0

MOTION CARRIED

Oath of Office administered by Corporation Counsel for Trustee Ernest A. Jette.

CONFIRMATION OF MAYOR'S APPOINTMENTS - None

UNFINISHED BUSINESS – RESOLUTIONS

R-26-001

Endorsers: Alderman Richard A. Dowd
Alderman-at-Large Ben Clemons
Alderman Patricia Klee
Alderman Derek Thibeault
Alderman-at-Large Michael B. O'Brien
Alderman-at-Large Alicia Gregg
Alderman John Sullivan
Alderman Tim Sennott
Alderman-at-Large Amber Morgan
Alderman-at-Large Lori Wilshire

APPROVING THE COST ITEMS OF A COLLECTIVE BARGAINING AGREEMENT BETWEEN THE NASHUA BOARD OF EDUCATION AND THE NASHUA TEACHERS' UNION, LOCAL 1044, AFT, AFL-CIO, UNIT E, INTERPRETERS FOR THE DEAF AND HARD OF HEARING AND UNIT F, FAMILY ENGAGEMENT COORDINATORS FROM JULY 1, 2025 THROUGH JUNE 30, 2028

Given its second reading;

MOTION BY ALDERMAN DOWD TO AMEND R-26-001 BY REPLACING IT WITH THE GOLDEN ROD COPY OF AMENDMENTS MADE AT THE BUDGET REVIEW COMMITTEE, , BY ROLL CALL

A viva voce roll call was taken, which resulted as follows:

Yea: Alderman Clemons, Alderman Klee, Alderman Chess, Alderwoman Smith, Alderman Thibeault, Alderman O'Brien, Alderman Gregg, Alderman Dowd, Alderman Sullivan, Alderman Sennott, Alderman Johnson, Alderwoman Kelly, Alderman Morgan, Alderman Lopez, Alderman Wilshire 15

Nay: 0

MOTION CARRIED

MOTION BY ALDERMAN DOWD FOR FINAL PASSAGE OF R-26-001 AS AMENDED, BY ROLL CALL

A viva voce roll call was taken, which resulted as follows:

Yea: Alderman Clemons, Alderman Klee, Alderman Chess, Alderwoman Smith, Alderman Thibeault, Alderman O'Brien, Alderman Gregg, Alderman Dowd, Alderman Sullivan, Alderman Sennott, Alderman Johnson, Alderwoman Kelly, Alderman Morgan, Alderman Lopez, Alderman Wilshire 15

Nay: 0

MOTION CARRIED

Resolution R-26-001 is declared duly adopted as amended.

R-26-003, Amended

Endorsers: Alderman-at-Large Ben Clemons
Alderman Derek Thibeault
Alderman Patricia Klee
Alderwoman Vengerflutta Smith
Alderman-at-Large Michael B. O'Brien
Alderman-at-Large Amber Morgan
Alderman Thomas Lopez
Alderman-at-Large Lori Wilshire

RELATIVE TO THE SUPPLEMENTAL APPROPRIATION OF $15,000 OF ASSIGNED FUND BALANCE INTO DEPARTMENT 161 "STREETS", ACCOUNT 51300 "OVERTIME", AND $40,000 OF ASSIGNED FUND BALANCE INTO DEPARTMENT 177 "PARKS", ACCOUNT 51300 "OVERTIME" FOR THE INTENDED PURPOSE OF COVERING EXPENSES RELATED TO THE CLEAN UP AND MAINTENANCE OF MAIN STREET, THE RIVERFRONT, AND THE LIBRARY WALK

Given its second reading;

MOTION BY ALDERMAN CLEMONS FOR FINAL PASSAGE OF R-26-003, AMENDED, BY ROLL CALL

A viva voce roll call was taken, which resulted as follows:

Yea: Alderman Clemons, Alderman Klee, Alderwoman Smith, Alderman Thibeault, Alderman O'Brien, Alderman Gregg, Alderman Dowd, Alderman Sullivan, Alderman Sennott, Alderwoman Kelly, Alderman Morgan, Alderman Lopez, Alderman Wilshire 13

Nay: Alderman Chess, Alderman Johnson 2

MOTION CARRIED

Resolution R-26-003 is declared duly adopted as amended.

R-26-007, Amended

Endorsers: Mayor Jim Donchess
Alderman Patricia Klee
Alderman Derek Thibeault
Alderman-at-Large Michael B. O'Brien
Alderman-at-Large Alicia Gregg
Alderman Richard A. Dowd
Alderman-at-Large Lori Wilshire

AUTHORIZING THE MAYOR AND CITY TREASURER TO ISSUE BONDS NOT TO EXCEED THREE MILLION DOLLARS ($3,000,000) FOR THE PUBLIC WORKS DIVISION GARAGE DESIGN

Given its third reading;

MOTION BY ALDERMAN THIBEAULT FOR FINAL PASSAGE OF R-26-007, AMENDED, BY ROLL CALL

A viva voce roll call was taken, which resulted as follows:

Yea: Alderman Klee, Alderman Chess, Alderwoman Smith, Alderman Thibeault, Alderman O'Brien, Alderman Gregg, Alderman Dowd, Alderman Sennott, Alderman Morgan, Alderman Lopez, Alderman Wilshire 11

Nay: Alderman Clemons, Alderman Sullivan, Alderman Johnson 3

Abstained: Alderwoman Kelly 1

MOTION CARRIED

Resolution R-26-007 is declared duly adopted as amended.

R-26-011

Endorsers: Mayor Jim Donchess
Alderman Patricia Klee
Alderman Derek Thibeault
Alderman-at-Large Michael B. O'Brien, Sr.
Alderman-at-Large Alicia Gregg
Alderman Richard A. Dowd
Alderman-at-Large Amber Morgan
Alderman Thomas Lopez
Alderman-at-Large Lori Wilshire

RELATIVE TO THE ACCEPTANCE OF $15,833 FROM THE NEW HAMPSHIRE DEPARTMENT OF HOMELLAND SECURITY INTO EMERGENCY MANAGEMENT GRANT ACTIVITY "SMART HAZMAT FY26"

Given its second reading;

MOTION BY ALDERMAN LOPEZ FOR FINAL PASSAGE OF R-26-011, BY ROLL CALL

A viva voce roll call was taken, which resulted as follows:

Yea: Alderman Clemons, Alderman Klee, Alderman Chess, Alderwoman Smith, Alderman Thibeault, Alderman O'Brien, Alderman Gregg, Alderman Dowd, Alderman Sullivan, Alderman Sennott, Alderman Johnson, Alderwoman Kelly, Alderman Morgan, Alderman Lopez, Alderman Wilshire 15

Nay: 0

MOTION CARRIED

Resolution R-26-011 is declared duly adopted.

R-26-013

Endorsers: Mayor Jim Donchess
Alderman Patricia Klee
Alderman-at-Large Michael B. O'Brien, Sr.
Alderman-at-Large Alicia Gregg
Alderman Richard A. Dowd
Alderman-at-Large Amber Morgan
Alderman-at-Large Lori Wilshire

RELATIVE TO THE SUPPLEMENTAL APPROPRIATION OF $280,000 OF ASSIGNED FUND BALANCE INTO DEPARTMENT 168 "SOLID WASTE", ACCOUNT #55520 "NHDES SURCHARGE FEE"

Given its second reading;

MOTION BY ALDERMAN O'BRIEN FOR FINAL PASSAGE OF R-26-013, BY ROLL CALL

A viva voce roll call was taken, which resulted as follows:

Yea: Alderman Clemons, Alderman Klee, Alderman Chess, Alderwoman Smith, Alderman Thibeault, Alderman O'Brien, Alderman Gregg, Alderman Dowd, Alderman Sullivan, Alderman Sennott, Alderman Johnson, Alderwoman Kelly, Alderman Morgan, Alderman Lopez, Alderman Wilshire 15

Nay: 0

MOTION CARRIED

Resolution R-26-013 is declared duly adopted.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS – ORDINANCES – None

BUSINESS UNFINISHED AT PREVIOUS MEETING

R-26-015

Endorsers: Mayor Jim Donchess
Alderman-at-Large Ben Clemons
Alderman Patricia Klee
Alderman Derek Thibeault
Alderman-at-Large Michael B. O'Brien, Sr.
Alderman-at-Large Alicia Gregg
Alderman Richard A. Dowd
Alderman-at-Large Amber Morgan
Alderman-at-Large Lori Wilshire

SUPPORTING THE TOWN OF MERRIMACK IN ITS OPPOSITION TO AN ICE DETENTION CENTER
- tabled at Board of Aldermen meeting on 2/24/26

NEW BUSINESS – RESOLUTIONS

R-26-018

Endorsers: Mayor Jim Donchess
Alderman Patricia Klee
Alderwoman Vengerflutta Smith
Alderman Derek Thibeault
Alderman-at-Large Michael B. O'Brien, Sr.
Alderman-at-Large Alicia Gregg
Alderman Richard A. Dowd
Alderman Tim Sennott
Alderwoman-at-Large Shoshanna Kelly
Alderman-at-Large Amber Morgan
Alderman Thomas Lopez
Alderman-at-Large Lori Wilshire

RELATIVE TO THE ACCEPTANCE OF AN ADDITIONAL $377,874 FROM THE STATE OF NEW HAMPSHIRE, DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES INTO TRANSIT GRANT ACTIVITY "FEDERAL TRANSIT AUTHORITY ("FTA") OPERATING GRANT"

Given its first reading, assigned to the Human Affairs Committee, by President Wilshire

NEW BUSINESS – ORDINANCES - None

PERIOD FOR GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

Billie Melin
Ben Heney
Hilary Keating
Sister Rosemary Burnham
Tom Sheehan
Fred Teeboom
Gayle Hoisington
Tori Markiewicz
Sklyar Wheeler
Pushpce Mudan
Christopher Smith
Kenneth Walter Frank Doveatte
Bob Keating

REMARKS BY THE MEMBERS OF THE BOARD OF ALDERMEN

Alderman Lopez

Alderman Morgan
Alderwoman Kelly
Alderman Johnson
Alderman Sennott
Alderman Sullivan
Alderman Dowd
Alderman Gregg
Alderman Thibeault
Alderwoman Smith
Alderman Chess
Alderman Klee
Mayor Donchess
Alderman Clemons

Committee announcements:

Alderman O'Brien
Alderman Dowd
President Wilshire

ADJOURNMENT

MOTION BY ALDERMAN CLEMONS THAT THE MARCH 24, 2026 MEETING OF THE BOARD OF ALDERMEN BE ADJOURNED, BY ROLL CALL

A viva voce roll call was taken, which resulted as follows:

Yea:	Alderman Clemons, Alderman Klee, Alderman Chess, Alderwoman Smith, Alderman Thibeault, Alderman O'Brien, Alderman Gregg, Alderman Dowd, Alderman Sullivan, Alderman Sennott, Alderman Johnson, Alderwoman Kelly, Alderman Morgan, Alderman Lopez, Alderman Wilshire	15
Nay:		0

MOTION CARRIED

The meeting was declared adjourned at 10:34 p.m.

Attest: Dan Healey, City Clerk

Graham, Donna

From: gravedirt@
Sent: Monday, March 23, 2026 10:55 AM
To: Graham, Donna
Subject: For the Board of Aldermen meeting on Tuesday, March 24th

CAUTION: This email came from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments if the source is unknown.

Dear Ms. Graham,

I am a Member at Large of the Nashua Theatre Guild Board of Directors. I understand that Nashua Theatre Guild is being considered for a grant, and that one of us from Nashua Theatre Guild should attend the Board of Aldermen meeting on Tuesday, March 24th at 7:15 to encourage final grant approval. I planned to attend and had a speech prepared, but I apologize that I cannot attend because I have rehearsal for our latest production, which is called The Littlefield Gazette Does Not End Today. In lieu of my attendance, please accept my speech via email.

Nashua Theatre Guild produces several plays a year. Our season begins in the summer with Shakespeare in the Park, which is a free event at Greeley Park, open to the public. We also put on full production plays in spring and autumn, and we feature local talent in February for our weekend of One Act Plays. We are a nonprofit organization, relying 100% on ticket sales, donations, and grants in order to run.

Why is theater important? Why should the arts be funded?

We could also ask, why are Shakespeare plays still put on over 400 years after his death? Especially when the language has changed so much, it can be difficult to understand.

His words may be difficult to understand, but his themes are not. Revenge. Jealousy. Love and longing. Fate. Betrayal. These are universal themes that continue to show up in our everyday lives, even to this day. They are timeless. The human experience shows up time after time--different scenarios, but the same stories.

And when we go to Greeley Park for an afternoon of Shakespeare, we not only get together to see some good theater, we gather to share and celebrate these human experiences. In historic Greeley Park, we are connected. We are united. We are not alone. We are all in this human experience together.

In current times, when disconnection is common and prevalent, theater brings us back to what connects us.

In this way, art adds values to our lives. Nashua Theatre Guild exists to bring this connection and joy to our community. As an actor who is, as we speak, across the street rehearsing to bring another story to life, I thank you sincerely for considering us as a recipient for an arts grant.